Oxygen Cylinder Inventory and Storage Control Policy

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1. Purpose

This document supports consistent control of portable oxygen cylinder inventory. Reliable inventory information helps Facilities coordinate routine replenishment with Supply Chain.

2. Scope

The policy applies to approved oxygen cylinder storage areas managed by Facilities. It does not cover bedside use, clinical decisions, or other medical gases.

3. Definitions

A full cylinder is a cylinder marked as ready for operational distribution. An approved storage area is a location listed in the Facilities medical gas storage register.

4. Background

Storage locations were consolidated during a renovation in 2024. This historical note explains why counts are now combined and is not an instruction to move cylinders.

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5. Requirements

5.1 Shift-start inventory count

At the start of every Facilities shift, the designated Facilities technician must count the full and empty oxygen cylinders in each approved storage area.

5.2 Minimum stock notification

When fewer than 18 full cylinders are available across the approved storage areas, the designated Facilities technician must notify the Facilities Duty Manager within 10 minutes of completing the count.

5.3 Inventory record

For every shift-start count, the designated Facilities technician must record the date, time, storage location, number of full cylinders, number of empty cylinders, and technician initials in the Oxygen Inventory Log.

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5. Requirements continued

5.4 Storage separation

Facilities staff must keep full and empty oxygen cylinders in separate labeled racks within each approved storage area.

5.5 Unresolved shortage escalation

If a minimum stock notification remains unresolved for 30 minutes, the Facilities Duty Manager must notify the Supply Chain Supervisor and record the escalation.

6. Explanatory material

For example, a count of 17 full cylinders is below a threshold of 18. The example demonstrates arithmetic only; it does not add another reporting step.

The most frequently used storage area is near the central service corridor. This observation may change as hospital operations change and is not a storage requirement.

Questions about log access can be directed to the Facilities administration desk. Contact details are maintained in the internal directory rather than in this policy.